The org-wide AI maturity ladder

Five levels from scattered experiments to AI built into how the work gets done, with the training each level needs.

36%

of employees feel adequately upskilled for AI, while 72% say the skills they need have shifted.

BCG AI at Work, 2026, ~12,000 people

66%

of office professionals have used AI tools at work that they believed company policy did not allow.

PagerDuty and Wakefield, a vendor survey, June 2026

62%

of 721 firms sit in the first two of four AI maturity stages, where financial performance is below industry average.

MIT CISR, Dec 2024

For leaders, HR and L&D teams responsible for AI adoption across the whole organization

Swipe →

01

Explore

People try AI on their own, often on personal accounts, and nobody knows what goes in.

- List the AI tools in use, including what is paid on cards and expense reports.
- Publish a one-page policy: approved tools, what never goes in, and who checks output.

> **Working when:** Everyone can name the approved tools and the never-paste list.

02

Equip

Everyone gets approved tools and hands-on training on their own tasks, not a generic demo.

- Run a 60-minute session per team, built on three of that team’s real tasks.
- Start a shared prompt library per role, kept where people already work.

> **Working when:** Weekly active users of approved tools rise, not just seat count.

03
Standardize

Each team agrees on the best way to do its recurring AI tasks and writes it down.

- Name one champion per team, with an hour a week to help others.
- Turn each team's top five recurring tasks into written workflows: the prompt, the model, and how the output gets checked.

> **Working when:** Someone new can follow a team's AI workflows on day one.

04
Automate

The highest-volume written workflows become agents connected to the systems they need.

- Train the builders, often ops staff and analysts, on agent tools, test sets and spend limits.
- Take each one through the agent rollout ladder: test set, shadow mode, guardrails, then scale.

> **Working when:** Each agent in production has an owner, a test set and a budget.

05

Compound

Agents and people share one store of company knowledge, and AI results are reviewed like any other investment.

- Keep a shared company wiki that every AI tool reads, with a named owner for each page.
- Review AI spend and results together every quarter, and retire the workflows that do not pay.

> **Working when:** AI spend and outcomes are reviewed in the same meeting.

Track every month

- Share of staff active each week on approved tools
- Share of staff trained on their own tasks
- Workflows written down, by team
- Agents in production, each with an owner
- Cost per task on the top workflows

Take the whole framework

Free, with sources for every number, and open source so you can copy it into your own wiki.

Read it, with sources

steeltownai.io/blog

Copy it, plus free agent skills

steeltownai.io/open-source

Talk it through

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